DAY 35 | PRE-READ

# When the World Moves On

A light read before Day 35. About 15 minutes, no code required.

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## Why read this?

An AI system that worked well at launch can slowly get worse, even if nobody touches it, because the world around it changes. Tomorrow you learn to spot these changes early, fix them, and automate the routine checks. It is the last teaching day before the capstone.

## 1. Maps go out of date

A city map from five years ago still looks correct, but new roads have opened and old ones closed. Using it today leads you astray. AI systems face the same problem, called **drift**.

| Kind of change | Everyday example |
|---|---|
| Users ask new things | A shop starts getting questions about a product it just launched |
| The right answer changes | The return period changes from 30 days to 14 days |
| Documents are out of date | The website still shows the old return policy |
| The AI itself changes | The provider updates the model and its style shifts |

## 2. Comparing then and now

Drift detection compares a recent period with a reference period: are questions longer, in different languages, about different topics? Simple statistics turn "it feels different" into a number with a threshold.

## 3. Improving with experiments

When quality drops, it is tempting to change many things at once. Good teams change one thing, measure it on the golden set, and keep it only if it helps. Often the fix is not a bigger model but a missing document.

> **Key idea:** most quality problems are data problems. Check the documents before blaming the model.

## 4. Let the schedule do the routine

Rebuilding indexes, checking for drift and running evaluations can all run automatically every night or week, alerting people only when something needs attention.

## 5. Preparing for the capstone

From Day 36 you work in teams on a five-day capstone project. Read the five project briefs this weekend and choose your top two.

## 6. Think about these before class

- Which policies or facts in your organisation changed in the last year?
- How would you notice that users had started asking about something new?
- Which routine checks in your work could run automatically?

*Henka (変化): change*